

Bench-press baby

Lie on your back on the floor with your knees bent and, supporting your baby carefully around her torso with your hands, raise her gently straight up in the air and down again. Make noises and silly expressions to encourage her to laugh. If she loves the sensation of being lifted up and down, turn this game into a set of bench presses, or push-ups, to tone your biceps as your baby has fun.



Take a trip to the playground

A busy playground with lots of other young children will fascinate your baby. She's old enough to sit in a baby bucket-shaped swing as you push her gently, or sit her on a baby slide, hold her around her waist if she can't sit without support, and walk alongside her as she slides down slowly. You can also put her in your lap as you move up and down on one end of a seesaw.

9 MONTH

Your baby may be ready for her first rocking toy. Try her on a baby rocker, holding her gently around the torso as it moves. If she enjoys it, borrow or buy a rocking toy, and sing “Rock-a-bye baby” as you rock her back and forth.

Rock-a-bye baby

Increase her vocabulary

Develop your baby's familiarity with different words by giving lots of emphasis to each word as you say it—for example, zip becomes “zzzippp”—and see if she can attempt to copy you.